

NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

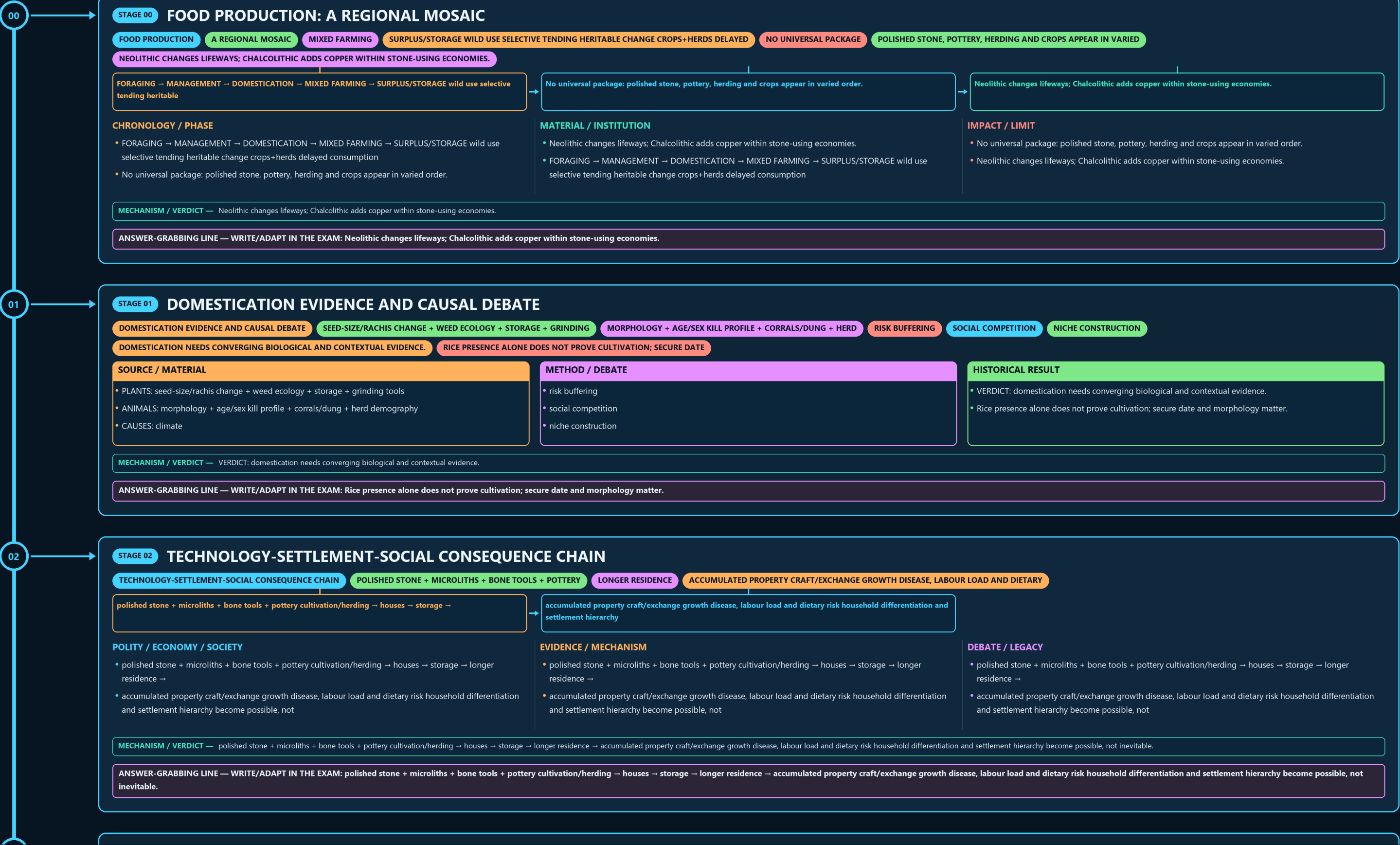
FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL → DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL → TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN → INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP → ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE → CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

02

STAGE 02 TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

POLISHED STONE + MICROLITHS + BONE TOOLS + POTTERY

LONGER RESIDENCE

ACCUMULATED PROPERTY CRAFT/EXCHANGE GROWTH DISEASE, LABOUR LOAD AND DIETARY

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage →

accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence →
- accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence →
- accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not

DEBATE / LEGACY

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence →
- accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not

MECHANISM / VERDICT — polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

03

STAGE 03 INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP

LONG FARMING/HERDING SEQUENCE BEFORE HARAPPAN URBANISM

BURZAHOM, GUFKRAL

PIT DWELLINGS, BONE TOOLS, AGRO-PASTORALISM

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA

KOLDIHWA, MAHAGARA, LAHURADEWA

RICE/DATE CAUTIONS

SHOULDERED CELTS AND REGIONAL LINKS; CHRONOLOGY REMAINS UNEVEN

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions

NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism
- KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions
- NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SOUTH: Utnur, Piklihal, Tekkalakota, Hallur → cattle, millets, ash mounds
- RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

04

STAGE 04 ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

ASH MOUNDS

FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT

SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND PERIODIC PEN BURNING COMMUNAL FEASTING

REPEATED FIRING AND CATTLE CENTRALITY ARE STRONG; ONE EXCLUSIVE

USE UTNUR AND RELATED SITES AS A PASTORAL-LANDSCAPE PROBLEM

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice
- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.

METHOD / DEBATE

- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.
- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice

HISTORICAL RESULT

- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.
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MECHANISM / VERDICT — Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

05

STAGE 05 CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS

GANESHWAR-JODHPURA GANESHWAR/JODHPURA COPPER CRAFT; HARAPPAN CONTACT

AHAR-BANAS AHAR, BALATHAL, GILUND BLACK-RED WARE; COPPER; FARMING

KAYATHA KAYATHA EARLY MALWA SEQUENCE; RICH DEPOSITS

MALWA NAVDATOLI, ERAN, NAGDA PAINTED WARE; LARGE VILLAGES; SPREAD

JORWE INAMGAON, NEVASA DECCAN HIERARCHY; LATE JORWE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

04

STAGE 04

ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

ASH MOUNDS

FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

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STAGE 05

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

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REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

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AHAR-BANAS AHAR, BALATHAL, GILUND BLACK-RED WARE; COPPER; FARMING

KAYATHA KAYATHA EARLY MALWA SEQUENCE; RICH DEPOSITS

MALWA NAVDATOLI, ERAN, NAGDA PAINTED WARE; LARGE VILLAGES; SPREAD

JORWE INAMGAON, NEVASA DECCAN HIERARCHY; LATE JORWE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS	Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits	OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact	Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread	
Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming	Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
- Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact
- Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
- Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread
- Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

DEBATE / LEGACY

- OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

MECHANISM / VERDICT — OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

06

STAGE 06

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

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VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS

CROP/HERD PRODUCTION

CRAFT WORK

EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS

SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND DIFFERENTIAL BURIALS MAY INDICATE INEQUALITY.

MOST SYSTEMS WERE REGIONAL AND RURAL, NOT FAILED HARAPPAN

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk

→ Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

→ Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks
- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.
- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.
- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

07

STAGE 07

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS

LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE

ARIDITY + PRODUCTION STRESS + SETTLEMENT REORGANISATION SOME ABANDONMENT

CAUTION 1

ARCHAEOLOGICAL CULTURE

MATERIAL PATTERN, NOT A NAMED PEOPLE.

CAUTION 2

COPPER USE DOES NOT DISPLACE STONE OR PROVE URBANISATION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.
- CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.
- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some

NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 4070-7304 of 9339 • continues below

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS

CROP/HERD PRODUCTION

CRAFT WORK

EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS

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POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks
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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.
- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.
- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

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STAGE 07

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CAUTION 1

ARCHAEOLOGICAL CULTURE

MATERIAL PATTERN, NOT A NAMED PEOPLE.

CAUTION 2

COPPER USE DOES NOT DISPLACE STONE OR PROVE URBANISATION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies
- + local continuity

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.
- CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.
- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

08

STAGE 08

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

DEFINE PHASE

TWO REGIONAL SITES

EVIDENCE CAUTION

15 MARKS

TRANSITION CAUSES

DOMESTICATION PROOF

10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution

→ 15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

→ 20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society

→ ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

→ Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution
- 15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society
- ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.
- CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Optional Advanced Case Clinics: Evidence Without Overreach — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- At Koldihwa, Mahagara, Pachoh and Indari, key issues are dates and whether rice remains are wild or domesticated.
- Upinder Singh also highlights Lahuradewa as evidence that the middle Ganga valley was an early rice-cultivation zone, preventing
- a single north-west-to-east diffusion model.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.